

PAULDING COUNTY HISTORY MUSEUM NEWSLETTER

Facebook.com/JPHSMUSEUM

July 2026

Editor – Judy Wells

Rest in Peace, Dear Friend



Elizabeth loved decorating the museum for Christmas and was the chairman of the annual Festival of Trees for many years.

Our dear friend, Elizabeth Miller, a long-time and dedicated volunteer at the museum, lost her courageous battle against lung cancer on Monday, June 22. As stated in her obituary, written by her daughter who is also named Elizabeth, “She had a real passion for the museum; she curated many, many displays, cared for the massive amount of vintage clothes, chaired several Teas, and chaired the Festival of Trees for several years. She was also a director for the museum.”

But that doesn’t even come close to describing the many tasks she performed or the giant hole that will be left in the hearts of her family, friends, and other volunteers here at the museum.

Elizabeth came to the museum nearly every day and worked on displays, decorated booths and kept rack of the many pieces of vintage clothing that had been donated. Often, she took pieces home to wash, clean or refurbish them. She spent countless hours and many dollars making things look perfect.

She once said that decorating the museum for Christmas was her passion, and that it wasn’t work for her but “a labor of love.” She truly enjoyed the season and all the festivities involved in the annual Festival, our biggest fund-raiser of the year.

Elizabeth is survived by her loving husband, Mike, her dad, Willard David Brown, her daughter Elizabeth (Tyler) See, her son, Andrew Guillian, one sister, Danielle (Bill) Farrel of Juneau, Alaska, brothers Patrick (Sarah) Brown of Seattle, Washington and David Brown III of Waterloo, Indiana, stepdaughter, Jessica Ace Stone, seven grandchildren, three great-grandchildren and several nieces and nephews. She was preceded in death by her mother, Mary Ann Brown and stepfather David Temple.



From the President's Desk



Summer is here and things have been busy around the museum. We have nearly finished the kitchen remodel! The north wall is all that is left to do, and we plan to complete that this month. We also plan to spruce up the men's and women's restrooms at the front of the museum this summer with a fresh coat of paint and some new fixtures and plumbing.

We just completed a very successful Quilt Show. Over 70 quilts were brought in for display by members of local quilt clubs, volunteers and friends. Also on display were old ironing boards and irons, antique sewing machines and other related antiques. We were open every day during the Paulding County Fair and over 100 visitors toured the museum and enjoyed the quilts and our displays throughout the museum. Guy Dasher and Jennifer White did a fantastic job organizing the event.

On a sad note, we lost one of our most dedicated volunteers, Elizabeth Miller, in June. She had chaired the Festival of Trees for several years and was also the chairman of the Ladies' Teas, held every year in the Spring. She was also the one who took care of our vintage clothing and other fragile artifacts. She will truly be missed.

Donations and artifacts arrive at the museum every week. One of our most recent gifts was a 7-1/2-inch gauge steam locomotive and caboose, with track, from Stan Searing. Stan is a long-time train enthusiast from Paulding and local collector of small-gauge trains. Thank you, Stan!

Plans are for a Family Fun night here at the museum in August with the Black Swamp Gleaners; date and time will be announced later. Games, trivia or a movie are all being discussed as possibilities

for entertainment. Refreshments will also be served. All proceeds will benefit the museum.



Some of the tractors at the Antique Tractor Show 2025

Our Antique Tractor Show will be on Saturday, September 19, the day before our annual ATHS Vintage Truck Show. Last year we had over two dozen tractors displayed and about that same number of hit-and-miss engines. We expect this year to be even bigger and better. There will also be several craft vendors on hand, as well as lots of good food to enjoy. More events, games and entertainment could be added as time for the event gets closer. Planning is still in the works, but the show is sure to be a hit with young and old alike! For more information on the Tractor Show, contact Guy Dasher at 419-796-7269.



Trophy winners at last year's Antique Tractor Show

Mel White, President

Quilt Show Draws over 100 Visitors



Many of the quilts at this year's show had a patriotic theme

Approximately 120 quilt enthusiasts visited the museum during our annual Quilt Show, held daily June 8-13 during the Paulding County Fair. Six volunteers from Patchwork Pals helped with set-up, take-down and during the display of the 70 quilts brought in for the show. Eight of our own volunteers helped as greeters and hosts all week as well.

Visitors came from far and wide, including Paulding and surrounding counties, Toledo, Columbus and Cleveland in Ohio; Fort Wayne, Indiana and Blissfield, Michigan. The guest who traveled the farthest distance was from Round Rock, Texas.

On June 13, the final day of the show, representatives of Threads of Love from Westgate Chapel Cares Ministry, Toledo, were on hand to share the story of their ministry.

Chris Tetzlaff and Kay Krempec shared that the organization had been making pieced and tied quilt tops for the past 23 years, then donating them to an orphanage in Chile, Quilts of Valor, the Pregnancy Center of Greater Toledo, Sandy Hook Elementary School families, That Neighborhood Church (TNC)

for their Christmas shopping event, The Family House in Toledo (an emergency shelter for the homeless), and Let's Build a Bed.

Visitors to the show were asked to vote on their favorite quilts. Diane Dasher won first and second place and Theresa Reineck won third. Raffle winners were Angie Pollock, Jane Nice, Sherry Wilhelm, Cathy Cronin, Guy Dasher, Janet Schuman and Pat Reinhart. The raffle raised nearly \$300 for the museum. Our thanks to Guy Dasher and Jennifer White for their hard work organizing this annual fundraiser!



Antique sewing machines, ironing boards and related items were seen at this year's annual Quilt Show, held June 8-13.

Anita's Corn Salad

For a refreshing treat on hot summer days, try this corn salad recipe.

2 cans whole kernel corn, drained

2 c. shredded cheese

1 c. mayonnaise

1 red pepper, diced

Diced sweet onion (optional)

Just before serving, crush up one bag Chili Cheese Fritos and add to salad.

Kitchen Remodel Nearly Complete

What has been a nearly eight-month project is almost finished! Our updated kitchen is done and we love it! Our volunteers worked most of the winter during our shut-down tearing out the old cabinets, fixtures and appliances. Following extensive work to the walls, plumbing and electrical system, new countertops, sinks, appliances, and cabinets were installed.

Improvements were made by Yenser & Gross, Vantage Vocational School, Momper Insulation, Paulding High School students and others. Several sizeable donations were received, plus grant money was made available, to help cover the cost of the project.

In the next phase of the project, beadboard matching that used in the kitchen will be installed on the north wall of the dining room. The garage door on that wall will be replaced with a swinging door. Plans are to hang a pull-down movie screen in front of the new door, then to mount our projector on the ceiling so movies can be shown on the screen. Our volunteers hope to finish the project later this month. Thank you to everyone who helped in any way, and to our dedicated volunteers for their hard work and long hours!



Building Our New Parade Float



Roger, Denny and Ryan spent many hours getting our float ready for the Summer Blast parade. We hope to use the float in other county parades this summer as well.

A donated flatbed wagon, a few boards and a box of screws were the beginning of our new parade float.

Our old float was becoming unsafe and was no longer roadworthy, so the decision was made to replace it. Thanks to a donation from one of our supporters, our guys were able to convert the donated wagon into a safe, useable and attractive new float, complete with fold-down aluminum steps! It's amazing what can be accomplished by a group of talented men with a few tools! Thanks guys!



Ryan, Roger, Dan, Gene, Mike and Denny did an excellent job!



Every year during the Paulding County Fair, several members of the FFA Alumni get together at the museum to sit in the air-conditioning and reminisce about the good ol' days at PHS.

CCAO/CEAO meet in Paulding



County Commissioners and Engineers meeting at PCHM

County leaders and engineers gathered April 8 at the Paulding County Fairgrounds and the Paulding County History Museum for the CCAO/CEAO Northwest District meeting.

Discussions focused on key issues facing Ohio's counties, including infrastructure, roadway systems and the growing need for jail funding. CCAO, CORSA and CEBCO staff provided updates to the group on advocacy and programs. The meeting also highlighted Paulding County's deep roots. The day wrapped up with tours of local industry, such as the Baughman Tile Company. Without drainage and land planning, of course, Paulding County wouldn't be the agricultural community it is today. (Information taken from CCAO website)

Kitchen Dedication



President Mel While, Brad and Bruce Weidenhamer and Amy (Weidenhamer) Borkosky

Family members of Les and Sandy Weidenhamer were on hand at the General Meeting on May 31 for the dedication of our new kitchen to their parents, Les and Sandy.

Les was President of the historical society for many years and dedicated much time and effort to its existence. When he passed away, Vice President Kim Sutton became President. Les always said his first love, after his family, was the museum. Sandy was also diagnosed with cancer several years later. As she was making her final arrangements before her passing, Sandy said she would like to leave a gift to the museum. When she learned we were getting ready to remodel the kitchen, Sandy told daughter Amy, "Oh, that makes me so happy!" and said she would like her contribution to go towards the kitchen project.

A plaque now hanging on the kitchen wall features a photo of Les and Sandy sitting on a swing and reads, "Les and Sandy, Together Forever. The Weidenhamer Kitchen."

Thank you, Weidenhamer family!

2026 Truck Show Coming Sept. 20



1939 Ford pick-up owned by John Henry Kauser, who started the ATHS Truck Show in 2000

This will be the 25th year for the ATHS Vintage Truck Show, held annually at the museum, and plans are well underway to make it one to remember. The show will be held on Sunday, Sept. 20 from 9 a.m. until 4 p.m. Lunch will be served in the newly remodeled museum kitchen from 11 a.m. to 1 p.m. with a variety of sandwiches, sides and desserts prepared by Patty Boundy and her crew.

The event began in the late 1990s. The late Dick Parrish of Oakwood, convinced John “Henry” Kauser to have “a vintage truck show” at the museum on the Sunday of the Flat Rock Creek Fall Festival. At that time, Henry was president of the Auburn Heritage Truck Club and was knee-deep in the planning of the American Truck Historical Society’s Truck Show/Convention in Auburn, Indiana in 2005. With the size of that show, there is a five-to-six-year planning process.



Dick and Henry collaborated to encourage more people to visit the museum during Festival week. On September 17, 2000, about 70 owners of antique trucks parked their vehicles on the grounds and attracted a large crowd of festivalgoers. A free-will lunch was also provided that day, a tradition which continues.

Henry, along with his family and friends, continued the show for 24 more years until his passing on March 12, 2025. The show at the museum was canceled in 2020 because of Covid-19. In its place, a “cruise” around the county was organized, with stops at several points of interest.

The Kauser family says the motivation of the show has always been to benefit the museum. Henry was an avid supporter of the historical society, and his family has carried on the tradition in his honor and for the love of the trucking industry.



There is no admission charge to the truck show and no entry fee, but donations are accepted and always appreciated. Parking is free as well. The show is held rain or shine. All proceeds benefit the historical society. Plaques will be awarded for the oldest truck and for the one that has traveled the farthest. For more information, visit kausertrucking.com or call Mike Kauser at 419-399-4856.

Festival of Trees Needs **YOU!**



Why in the world would we be thinking about Christmas in the middle of July?? Because our Festival of Trees will be here before we know it and we have already started planning this annual event! This year's theme is "A Few of My Favorite Things."

The Festival of Trees is our largest fundraiser of the year. We depend on the proceeds of the event to maintain the museum and cover other expenses throughout the year.

Last year, nearly 3,000 visitors came from far and wide to view over 80 decorated trees, Nativity sets, toy and train displays and to enjoy the musical entertainment and meals. The silent auction was a huge success, and the high bidders were excited to take home their prizes.

But all this work and excitement take many hands to make it successful. If you would like to join the committee to help plan the Festival, work in the kitchen, help decorate the museum, make phone calls or send out letters, or assist in any other way, please volunteer your time. Even if you can only help for a few hours or a couple days, we would love to have you! There are many, many jobs to be done to make this year's Festival successful.

Call the museum on any Tuesday and let us know what you are interested in helping with. Or better yet just come out and join us! We'll show you around the museum, introduce you to our wonderful volunteers and share our potluck lunch! We hope to see you soon!

Recent Donations to PCHM

It's been a busy few months here at the museum! A variety of items have been donated by county residents and supporters from around the states.

Some of our most recent acquisitions include a mini camera that measures 1"x2"; two football charms from the 1957 undefeated PHS football team; a 1941 Smith Corona typewriter; a bright orange tomato-shaped tea pot with matching sugar and creamer, salt and pepper shakers; a Great Band-era record set from 1933-1945; a child's tea set from the 1930s; a 1930s chrome coffee urn set with tray, sugar bowl and creamer; a baby's comb and brush set; a Friendship quilt made by the Latty Community Club; a picture of the 1938 Paulding High School graduating class; an album from the Indiana Clowns baseball team; a yellow Roseville mixing bowl; a painting of the Latty Methodist Church signed "Eachus"; a 1946 photograph of the Latty Methodist Church Sunday School class; and a 7-1/2-inch gauge steam locomotive, caboose and track. (You'll see more about that in a future newsletter!)



Engine, caboose and track recently donated to the museum by a local train enthusiast.

Paulding County History Museum

600 Fairground Drive

P.O. Box 93

Paulding, OH 45879



WE WANT TO HEAR FROM YOU!

Do you have suggestions for an event, exhibit, or presentation topic? Your input is appreciated. Please email your ideas to jphs45879@yahoo.com or talk to any officer or director.

Become a member – join today!